TRT 11

Letrozole

Non-steroidal aromatase inhibitor taken by mouth; blocks the enzyme that turns androgens into estrogens



CLASS
Small molecule (aromatase inhibitor)

STUDIED FOR
Breast cancer; low T in men

HUMAN EVIDENCE
Large trials; FDA approved

US STATUS
FDA approved (Femara) · men off-label

STUDIED FOR

- **Breast cancer** — HUMAN
- **Testosterone in men** — HUMAN
- **Sperm production** — HUMAN
- **Testes (young rats)** — ANIMAL

Use in men is off-label. In a 42-man placebo-controlled trial, hormones changed but none of the planned clinical endpoints did.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Letrozole ▶ Aromatase ▶ Less estradiol ▶ More LH, T

- **Label:** binds and blocks aromatase, lowering estrogen in all tissues
- **Label:** no significant effect on cortisol-type, aldosterone or thyroid hormones
- **In men,** less estradiol weakens its brake on the pituitary; LH and T rise

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- Approved on large trials in women (BIG 1-98)
- Men: 12-man pilot, 42-man RCT, 296-man RCT
- Sperm category rose: 14.3% vs 5.4%

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term use in men
- Male fertility effects
- Dose for men

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE
About 2 days (label)

ROUTES STUDIED
By mouth (tablets)

PHARMACOKINETICS
Fully absorbed; about 90% recovered in urine (label)

SOLD AS
Prescription tablets (Femara, generics); men off-label

MONITORED IN TRIALS
Bone density, cholesterol (label)

SPORT (WADA)
Prohibited, class S4

REGULATORY

FDA	Approved 1997 for breast cancer (women)
FDA	Use in men is off-label
WADA	Prohibited at all times (S4.1)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Femara prescribing information, Jun 2026
2. Eur J Endocrinol, letrozole vs placebo in obese men (Loves et al.), Nov 2013
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

Adonis Men's Health · checked Nov 2026. Research and regulator records only. Not medical advice.

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